



What Game Is Bezos Playing?

REVIEW

WSJ

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL WEEKEND



The Paris Most Tourists Miss

OFF DUTY

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What's News

Business & Finance

- ◆ **Microsoft in May** will shut down Skype, the service for making calls over the internet that it bought in 2011 for \$8.5 billion. **B9**
- ◆ **BASF expects earnings** to increase slightly this year because of cost savings that will offset continued investment in a big petrochemical site in China and a tough economic environment. **B10**
- ◆ **CME Group**, the biggest U.S. futures exchange, says it plans to list futures contracts on solana, deepening its presence in crypto. **B11**
- ◆ **Allianz raised** its dividend and said it would buy back shares after net profit rose in last year's final quarter. **B11**
- ◆ **Intel said it is delaying** construction of a \$28 billion semiconductor project in Ohio by about five years. **B10**
- ◆ **The Federal Reserve's** preferred gauge of inflation inched closer to the central bank's 2% target in January. **A2**
- ◆ **A Citigroup employee** accidentally moved to transfer \$81 trillion to a customer, but the bank said its controls reversed the error. **B11**
- ◆ **U.S. stocks rose** Friday with the Dow gaining 1.4% and the S&P 500 and Nasdaq each rising 1.6%, but all three indexes notched losses for February. **B11**

World-Wide

- ◆ **Trump excoriated** Ukrainian President Zelensky, accusing him of "gambling with World War III" in a meeting that was supposed to reset relations between Washington and Kyiv but devolved into a clash. **A1, A8**
- ◆ **Arab states are united** in opposition to Trump's idea of a U.S. takeover of Gaza, but they disagree over how Gaza should be run and what role Hamas should play. **A1**
- ◆ **Defense Secretary Hegseth** warned Mexico security officials the U.S. was ready to take unilateral military action against drug cartels, a threat hanging over trade talks. **A2**
- ◆ **Trump's tariff threat** against Canada has bolstered the Liberal Party, which has a 2-point lead in polls over the Conservatives, who led by 26 points six weeks ago. **A6**
- ◆ **Trump is planning** to sign an executive order that would for the first time in the U.S.'s nearly 250-year history make English the official language of the country. **A3**
- ◆ **A jury found** an Illinois landlord guilty of murder and hate-crime charges for a brutal 2023 attack on a Palestinian-American family that killed a 6-year-old. **A4**
- ◆ **Chinese authorities** are instructing top artificial-intelligence entrepreneurs and researchers to avoid visiting the U.S., people familiar with the matter said. **A6**

OPINION

AI could usher in a new renaissance **A15**

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Trump-Zelensky Meeting Implodes



A White House meeting between Ukraine's President Volodymyr Zelensky and President Trump and Vice President JD Vance erupted into a heated exchange Friday. See A8 for more coverage and to scan a code for video of the Oval Office clash.

'Your Country Is in Big Trouble'

By ANNIE LINSKEY AND NATALIE ANDREWS

WASHINGTON—President Trump said he would take one more question—and then everything fell apart.

It had been a relatively polite Oval Office meeting between Trump and President Volodymyr Zelensky of Ukraine, who was in Washington on a mission to secure the U.S.'s continued support in his campaign to end Russia's three-year-old war.

But Vice President JD Vance interjected. "I have to respond," he said, taking issue with reporters' questions about Trump's interactions with President Vladimir Putin of Russia. "What makes America a good country is America engaging in diplomacy. That's what President Trump is doing," Vance said.

Zelensky shot back, laying out Putin's yearslong campaign to occupy Ukraine. From there, the conversa-

tion devolved into a tense and personal argument that played out on television cameras in front of millions of viewers, stunning senior officials in Washington and Kyiv and threatening a U.S.-Ukraine deal that could have laid a pathway for bringing the war to a close.

The meeting ended with Trump declaring that the beleaguered nation didn't want his help reaching a cease-fire—and the U.S. president's team asking Zelensky to leave

the White House, according to U.S. and Ukrainian officials.

It was also a rare moment of public tension in the Oval Office, which has for years been the staging ground for tightly choreographed interactions between U.S. presidents and world leaders. Earlier in the day, a meeting between Zelensky and a bipartisan group of Senate allies ended with talk of unity and smiling selfies.

"I think it's disrespectful

U.S. president scolds Ukrainian leader, leaves proposed deal on minerals unsigned

President Trump excoriated President Volodymyr Zelensky of Ukraine, accusing him of "gambling with World War III" in a meeting that was supposed to reset relations between Washington and Kyiv but devolved into a clash that ended when Trump cut Zelensky's White House visit short.

By Michael R. Gordon, Annie Linskey and Ian Lovett

The two leaders didn't sign a proposed mineral deal as planned and canceled a joint news conference.

"He disrespected the United States of America in its cherished Oval Office," Trump wrote in a social-media message. "He can come back when he is ready for Peace."

Ukraine had sought the meeting to line up U.S. support against Russian aggression, which it hoped to solidify with the mineral agreement. But tensions between Zelensky and Trump burst into the open in the Oval Office as the Ukrainian leader urged the U.S. not to trust President Vladimir Putin of Russia and Trump responded that it has a weak negotiating hand, three years after Russia's full-scale invasion.

After a half-hour of a generally polite discussion, the tone grew fractious, with disagreements that typically occur behind closed doors. The abrupt ending left unclear how much military and political support the Trump administration was prepared to provide.

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◆ **Future of Ukraine peace deal is in doubt.....** A8

Inside DOGE's Federal Takeover

A surprise incursion, shrouded in secrecy; 'rogue bureaucrats' fight back

WASHINGTON—At 12:01 p.m. on Jan. 20, as Donald Trump was being sworn in as president for the second time, programmers linked to

By Scott Patterson, Josh Dawsey and Brian Schwartz

Elon Musk's nascent government-efficiency project wanted to access computer systems within the U.S. Office of Personnel Management.

Senior officials at OPM,

the government's human-resources arm, didn't help, but Musk's programmers quickly found assistance in an unlikely source: Chuck Ezell, a midlevel OPM information-technology supervisor from Georgia who had just been named acting director.

By roughly 12:30 p.m., the programmers had gained entry to a vast trove of information about the entire fed-

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◆ **Government contractor is in crosshairs.....** A11

How to Storm the Court Without Costing Your School \$500,000

Schools are trying to teach fans restraint to avoid big fines. It's a work in progress.

By LAINE HIGGINS

With 24 seconds left on the clock and her team clinging to a five-point lead over Kentucky, Vanderbilt athletic director Candice Storey Lee wound her way down to the front of the student section. With hands pressed together as if in prayer, she made a desperate plea: celebrate if you must, but don't storm the court.

Failure to do so, she explained, would trigger a \$500,000 fine. She would much

rather spend that dough on attracting better players with endorsement deals than donate it to Kentucky, a basketball blue blood not hurting for cash.

The fans ignored Lee and rushed the court immediately after the buzzer.

"We have a very tightknit community and they want to share the space," she said.

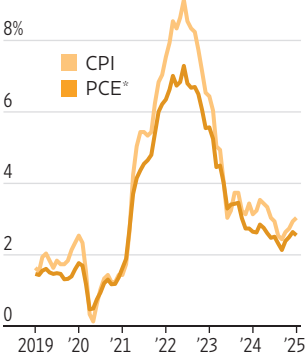
The Southeastern Conference is having a historic season with as many as 13 teams poised to earn bids to next

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Key Inflation Metric Eases

The Fed's preferred gauge of inflation inched closer to the 2% target in January. **A2**

Consumer-price indexes, change from a year earlier



*Seasonally adjusted
Sources: Labor Department (CPI); Commerce Department (PCE)

Arab Leaders Split Over Role of Hamas

By SUMMER SAID AND BENOIT FAUCON

DUBAI—As Arab leaders look to extend the cease-fire in the Gaza Strip and come up with an alternative to President Trump's plan to depopulate the enclave, they are being forced to deal with a question they have long kicked down the road: What to do with Hamas.

The first phase of the cease-fire, which saw the release of 33 Israeli hostages in exchange for hundreds of Palestinian prisoners, is set to end Saturday. Looming ahead are talks concerning the next phase, which is supposed to lead to the release of the re-

maining hostages, a permanent end to the fighting in Gaza and reconstruction of the war-ravaged enclave.

The rub is if Hamas remains in Gaza, Israel isn't willing to end the war, and Gulf Arab states such as the United Arab Emirates aren't willing to fund its reconstruction. Egypt, meanwhile, thinks it is unrealistic to talk about eliminating Hamas and is looking for a solution that would at least dilute the authority of the group, which ruled Gaza for a decade and a half before leading the Oct. 7

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◆ **Syrian city is model for new leadership.....** A10

Treatments Offer Hope On Pancreatic Cancer

By BRIANNA ABBOTT

Pranathi Perati was running out of time to treat her stage-four pancreatic cancer when she found out she would get another shot: a clinical trial testing a new experimental drug.

Perati's odds were slim—only 3% of late-stage pancreatic cancer patients are still alive after five years. And half of all pancreatic cancer patients live for less than a year after their diagnosis. For Perati, the drug, daraxonrasib from Revolution Medicines, has helped keep her alive for 17 months and counting.

"Someone told me once that I hit the clinical-trial lottery, and I definitely feel that way," said Perati, a 54-year-old molecular biologist in Cupertino, Calif., who is fighting pancreatic cancer a second time. "I see a lot of hope."

Pancreatic cancer is one of the toughest cancers to treat. Often caught late, it kills nearly 52,000 people in the U.S. each year, making it the country's third leading cause of cancer death, behind lung and colorectal. Case rates have gradually increased, particularly among younger women, in part because of rising obe-

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EXCHANGE



THE BIG COMEBACK
Financial wizardry crashed the economy in 2008. It's booming again. **B1**